

- road characteristics
- number of incidences, conflicts or hazards on the road. Where the frequency of incidents, conflicts or hazards on a road increase, the maximum safe speed of travel needs to be reviewed.

The Designer should ensure reduced speed zones are as short as possible and that they are not commenced so far prior to the hazard (or workers) that drivers start to disregard them and speed up. There is a balance between ensuring drivers can reduce speed prior to a hazard and not making that distance so long that compliance becomes an issue.

Speed limits implemented to meet specified safe workplace requirements for the protection of workers in an active work area should commence a minimum of a single sign spacing in advance of the active work area. The 200 m zone requirements past a speed limit reduction apply when determining this sign spacing value.

When considering the extent of the reduced speed beyond the work area, the guidance in Section 5.12 should be used, while remembering that offset speed zone requirements and the need to reduce traffic speeds past the work area for the other direction of travel may dictate the speed sign locations.

Figure 5.5.1 illustrates an example of a speed reduction arrangement for road worker safety on a 60 km/h road where road workers will be working within 1.2 m of the traffic lane and the speed past the workers is to be reduced to 40 km/h. The distance in advance of the workers for the start of the 40 km/h reduced speed zone is based on appropriate sign spacing in Table 2.2. As this spacing is within 200 m of a speed limit change (to 40 km/h), the speed value to use in Table 2.2 is 60 km/h which equates to a distance of 45 m. This Figure does not include all traffic control devices required and is not to be used as a TGS diagram.